

Speed Up Windows7 For Faster Performance



By Amit Banerjee

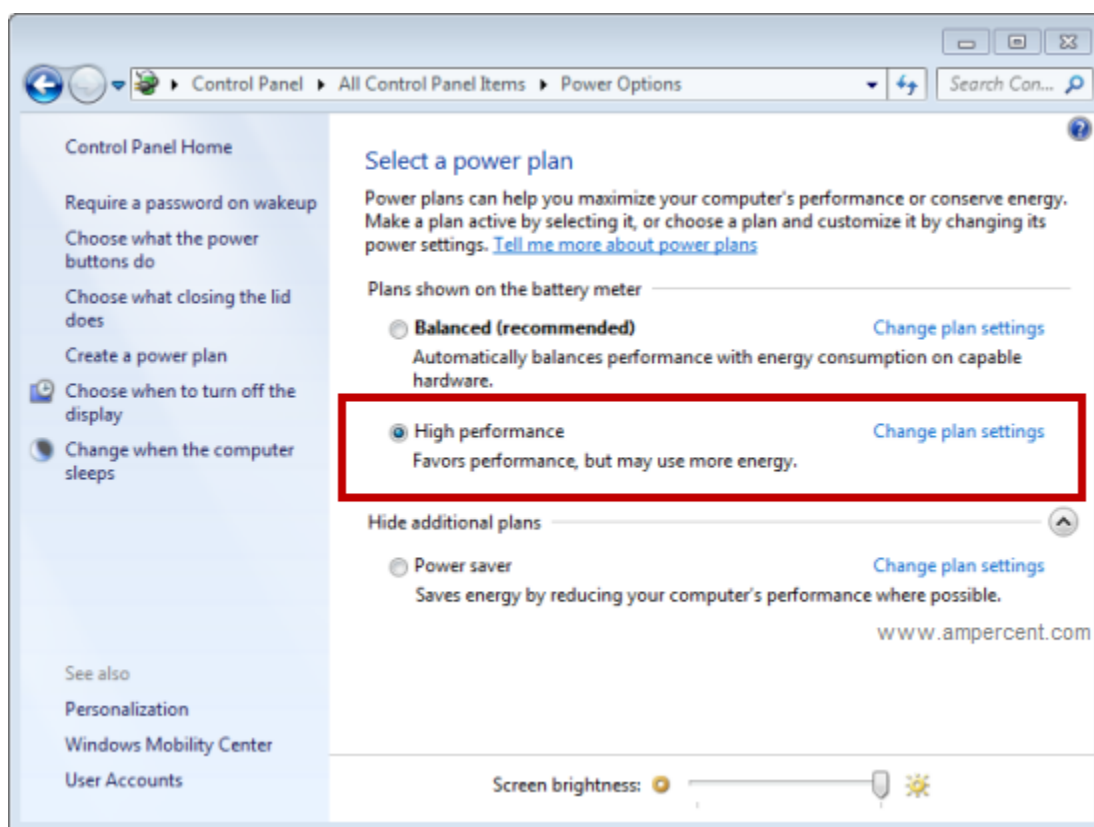
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Adjust Power Settings

The default power management plan in Windows7 is "Balanced", this saves your battery power at the cost of low performance. If you use a desktop computer or use your Laptop always plugged in, then there is no reason why you should stick to the "Balanced" power plan.

If you want to increase the performance of Windows7, consider switching to the "High performance" Power plan.

To change the Power options, click Start menu and go to the Control panel. Click the "Power options" link and choose "High performance" as shown below:

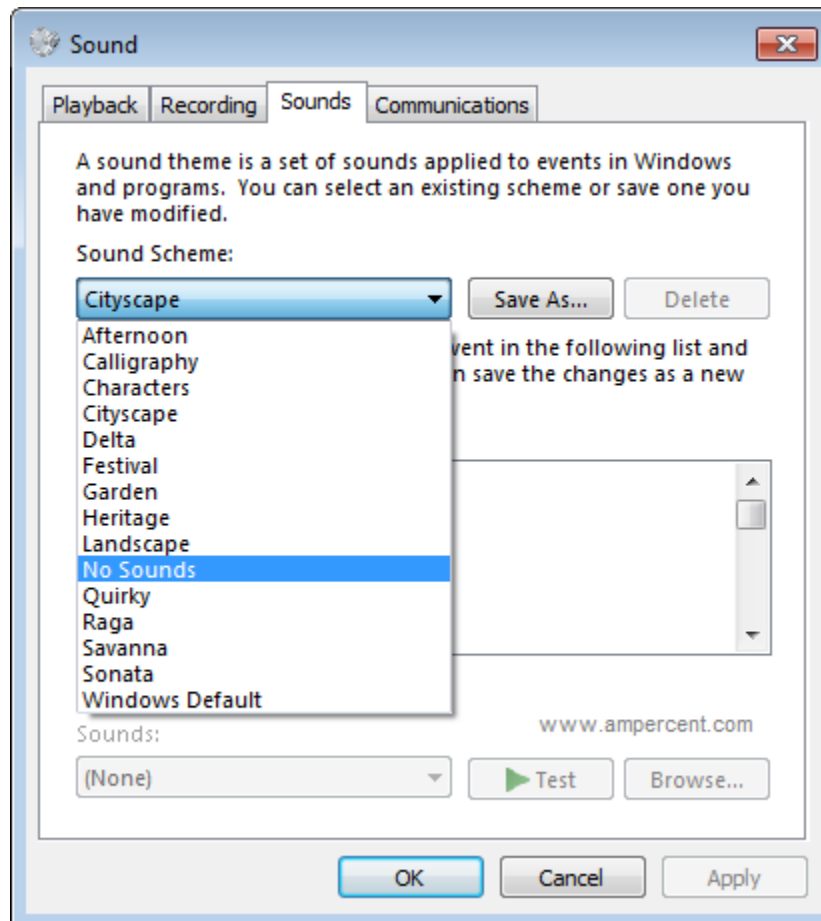


Note: If the "High Performance" Power plan isn't visible, you have to click through the small arrow at the right.

Disable Unwanted Windows Sounds

The more sounds you use, the more resources are required by Windows. To gain some extra performance, you should disable unwanted sound effects in Windows 7

1. Open Windows Control Panel and click the "Sound" link.
2. Switch to the "Sounds" tab and choose "No Sounds" under the Sound scheme dropdown.



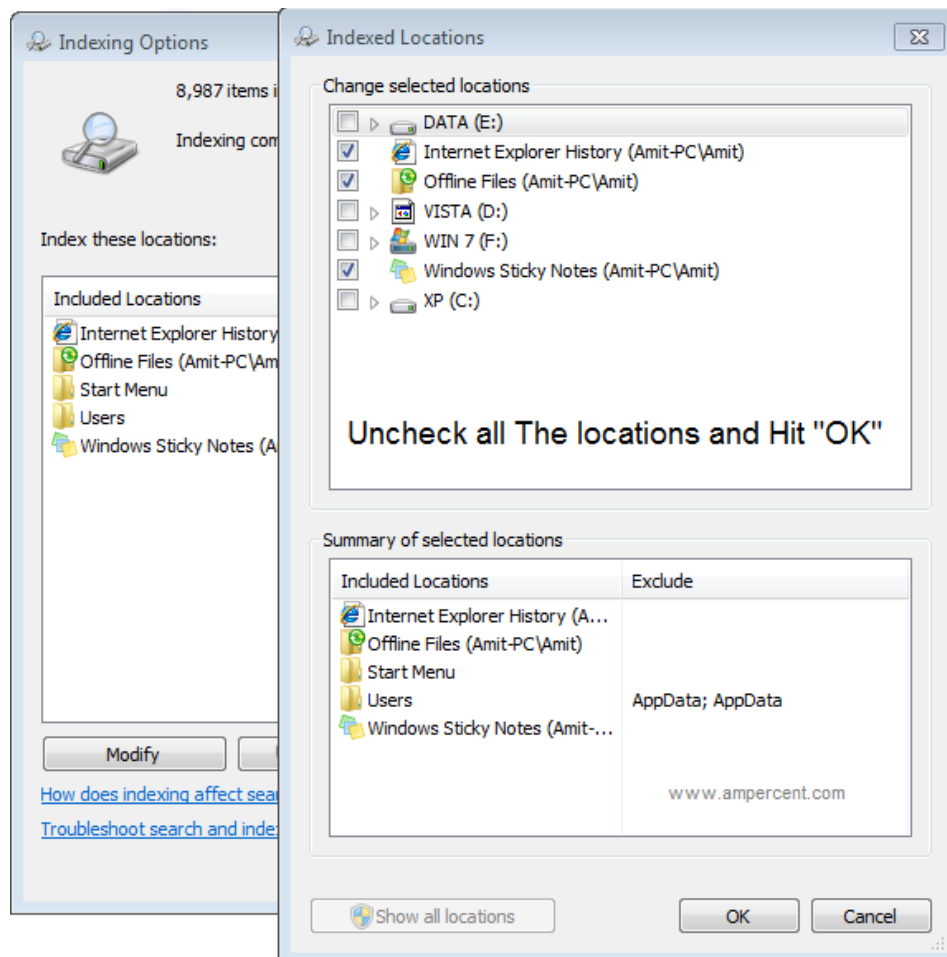
If you want to use only specific sounds like system startup and system shutdown, you have to create your own sound scheme. In the program events section, choose the sounds you want and remove those you don't want, then save the setup as a new sound scheme.

Disable Windows7 Search Indexing

Do you use the Search feature in Windows 7? Almost 90% of the users do not use the Search box to search for files, folders or programs in Windows. The search indexing feature in Windows7 manages an index to keep track of all the files, folders and programs in your system. This is to ensure that these files or folders appear in the search results when you use the Windows7 search.

Windows continuously indexes all the drives in your computer. The search indexing feature uses heavy system resource and turning it off will surely improve your Windows 7 performance

To disable the Search indexing feature in Windows7, open Control panel and click "Indexing options". Now click "Modify" and uncheck all the locations used for Windows 7 search indexing.

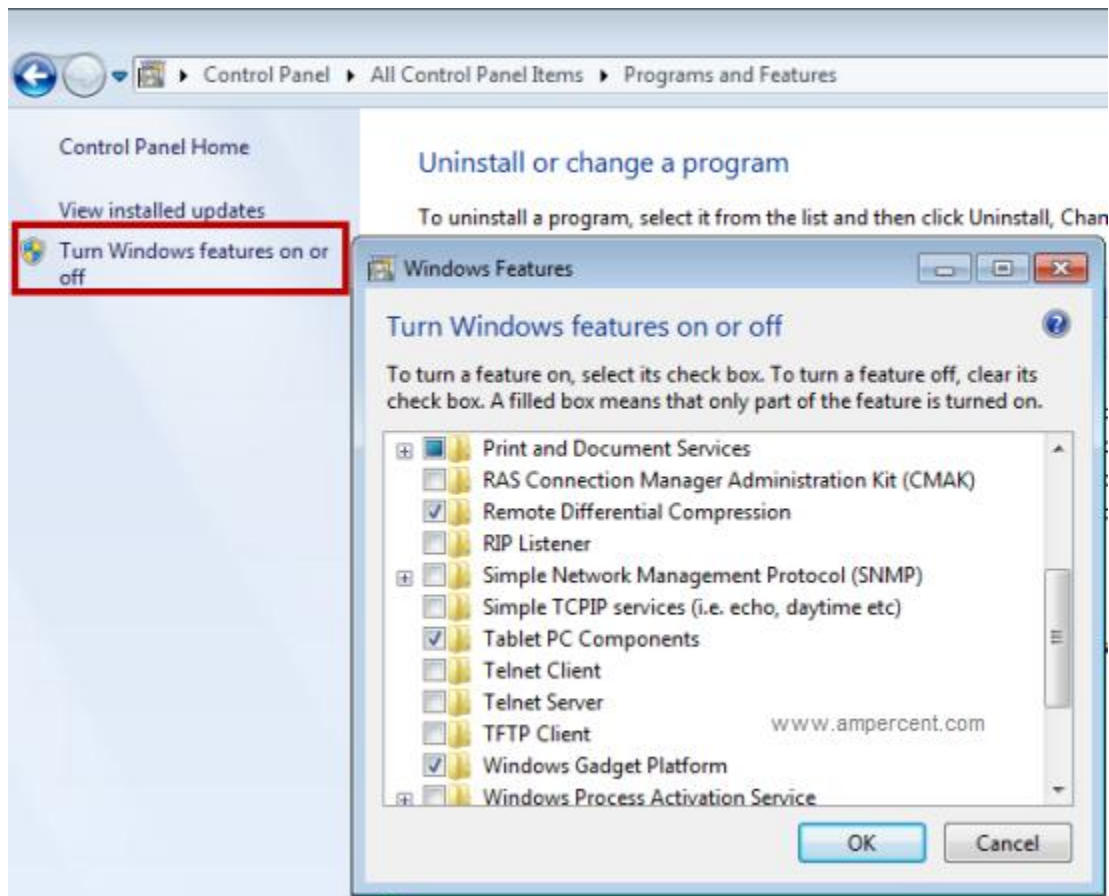


Turn Windows Features On or Off

There are some Windows features which you rarely use. When Windows boots, the system checks whether these feature are activated or not, regardless of whether you actually use it. This in turn causes the memory to be wasted for nothing.

Some of the examples of Windows features which you may not use may be Micrisif .NET framework, Windows Movie maker, Internet Printing Client, WIndows gadget platform to name a few.

To disable these specific Windows features permanently, go to control panel > Programs and features. Click “Turn Windows Features on or off” from the left sidebar and uncheck the features and services which you never use.

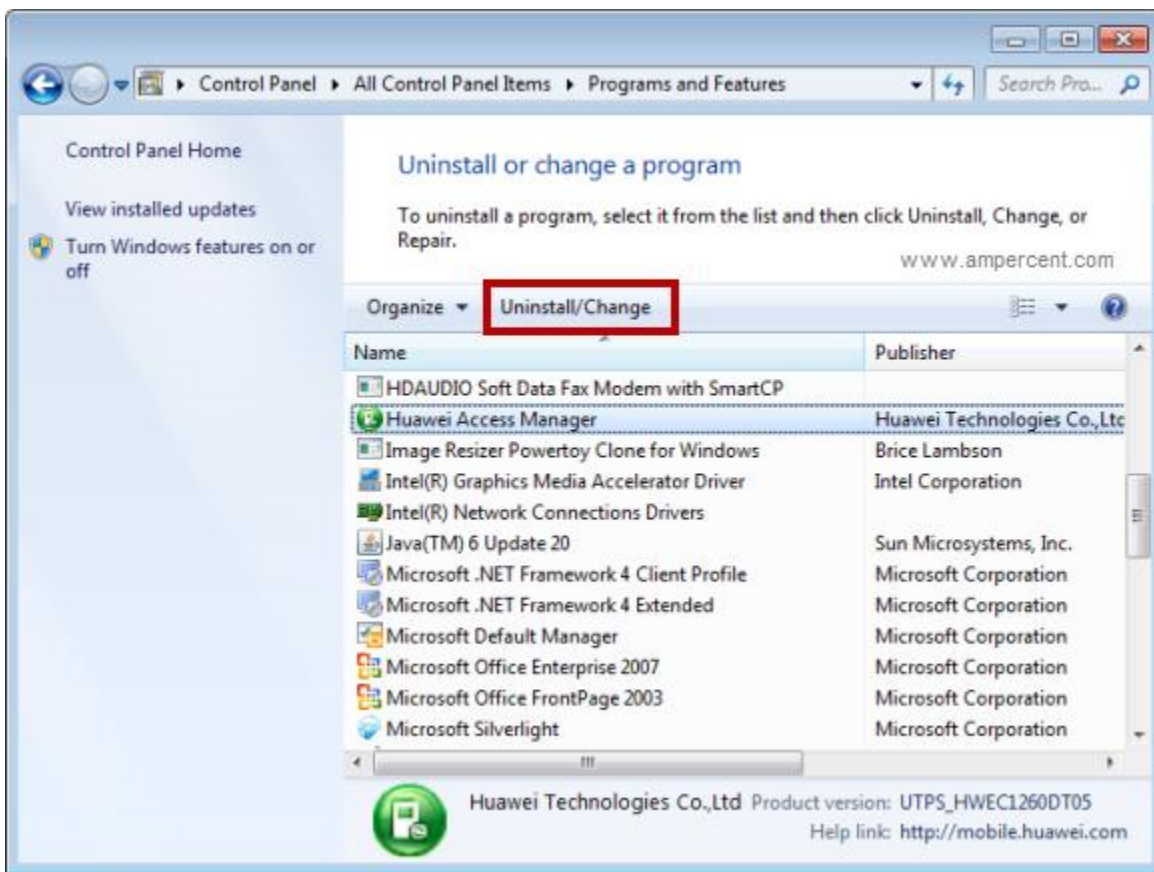


Then Hit “OK” and the system will prompt you to restart your computer. You can restart later if you want to carry on with the next tweaks as mentioned in this document.

Completely Remove the Programs You Never Use

Some computers come with pre-installed programs and software you might not need. As time passes by, you download and install various software which consequently uses system resources. If you rarely use these programs, consider cleaning them up from your operating system

To remove unwanted programs from Windows 7, go to Control Panel and select "Programs and Features". Then select the program from the drop down list and click on "Uninstall"



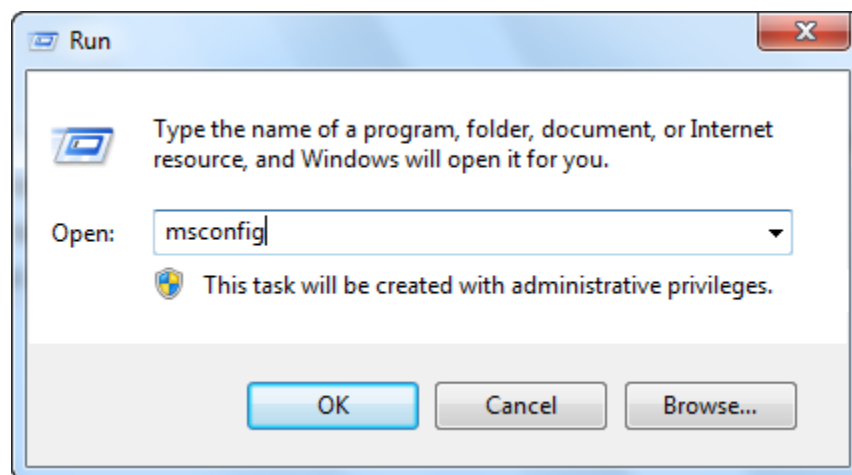
This will trigger a Windows uninstaller and you can follow the uninstallation wizard to completely remove the specific program from your computer.

Speed Up Windows 7 Booting Time By Disabling Unwanted Startup Items

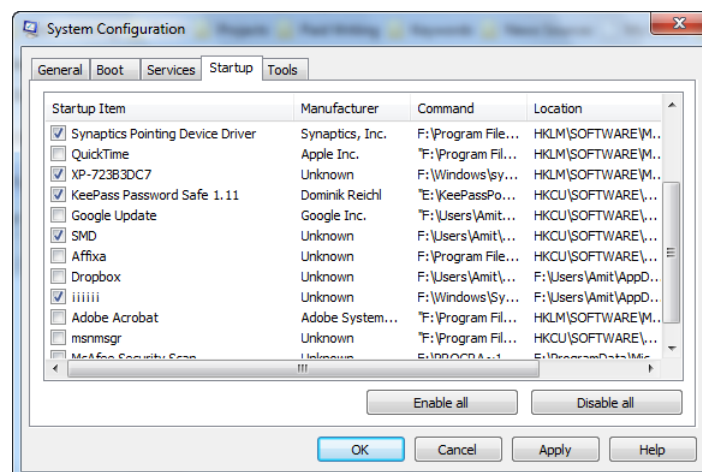
One of the common causes of slow system startup is the number of programs associated with Windows startup. As you install more and more programs in your computer, these programs start automatically with Windows and continue running in the background.

Preventing such unnecessary services from starting up during Windows7 startup can greatly reduce the startup time. To disable Windows7 startup items, follow these steps:

1. Open the "RUN" command from Accessories > Run and type **msconfig**. Then hit "Enter"



2. Go to the "Startup" tab and uncheck those programs which you don't need to run during startup.



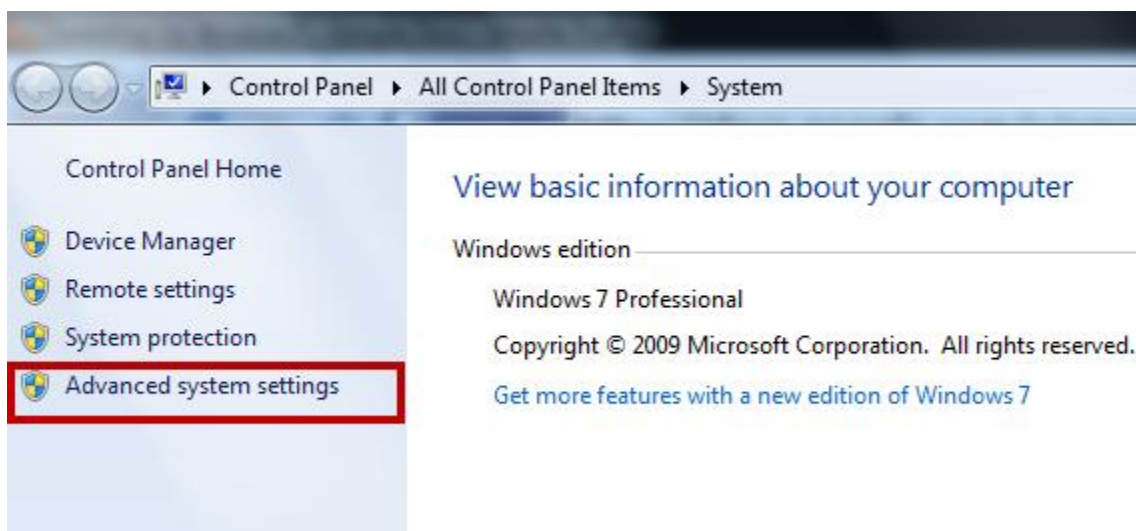
3. Click “Apply” and then “Ok”.

You will have to restart the computer for the changes to take effect.

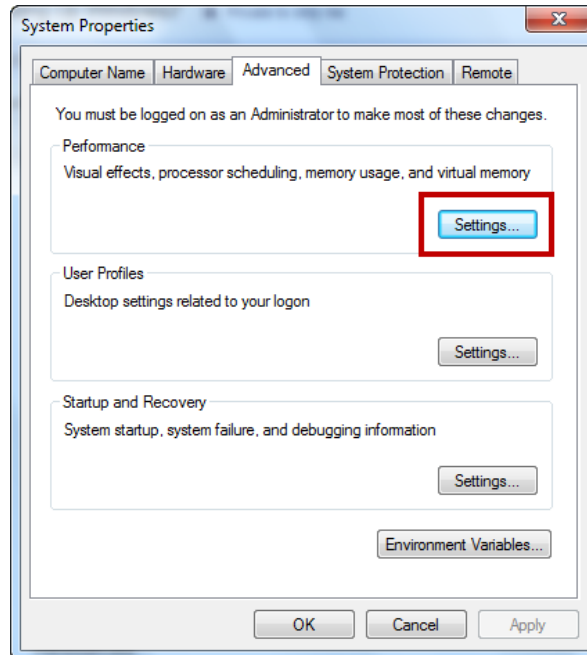
Adjust Windows Visual Effects For Maximum Performance

Windows 7 has a lot of visual effects which may be one of the reason for slow performance, if your computer has a low RAM (512 Mb). You can adjust Windows visual effects for maximum performance and disable some features to get an extra performance boost.

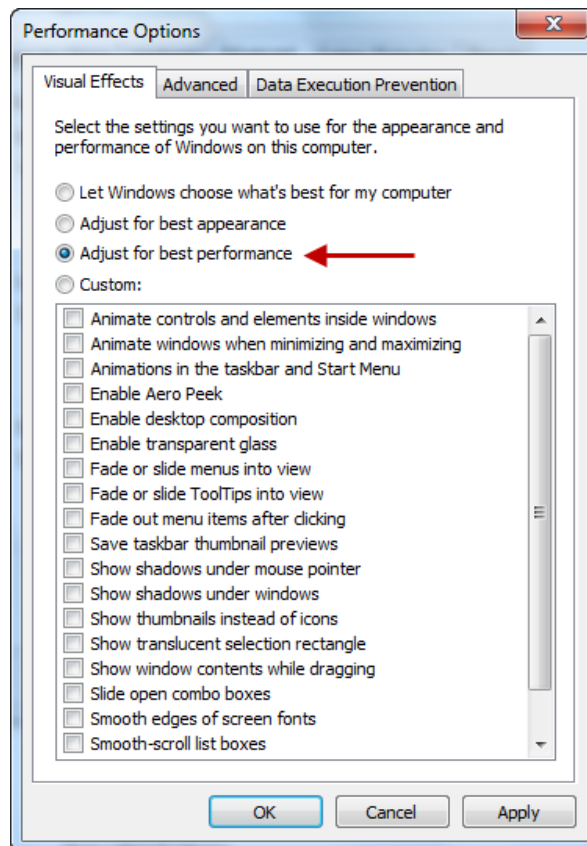
1. From the start menu, right click Computer and select Properties
2. Click “Advanced System Settings”



3. Under the “Advanced” tab, click “Settings” under the performance section



4. Under the Visual Effects Tab, select the radio button “Adjust for best performance”. Then click Apply and then OK.



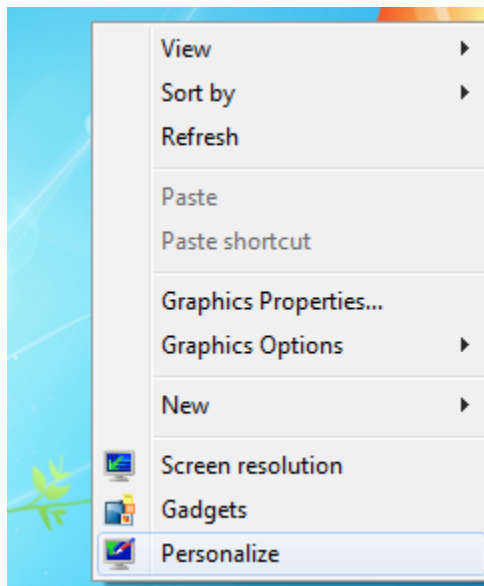
This will switch Windows to the Classic theme and you will experience a better speed.

Disable The Aero Theme in Windows 7

The Aero them in Windows 7 can result in high memory consumption and if your computer has become slower than before, consider turning off the Windows7 Aero theme for a slight increase in performance.

To turn off the Windows7 Aero theme off, follow these steps:

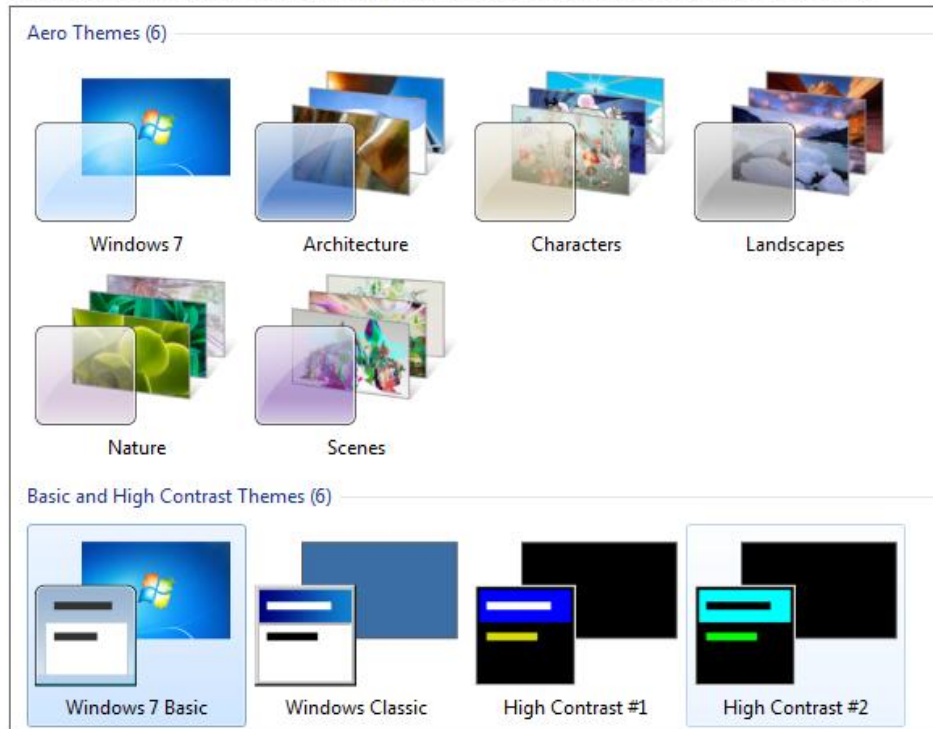
1. Right click on desktop and select “Personalize”



2. In the following window, you will two section of themes. One of them is Windows7 Aero themes at the top while the other one is Windows 7 Basic themes. Pick any basic theme from the Windows 7 Basic themes section, as shown below:

Change the visuals and sounds on your computer

Click a theme to change the desktop background, window color, sounds, and screen saver all at once.

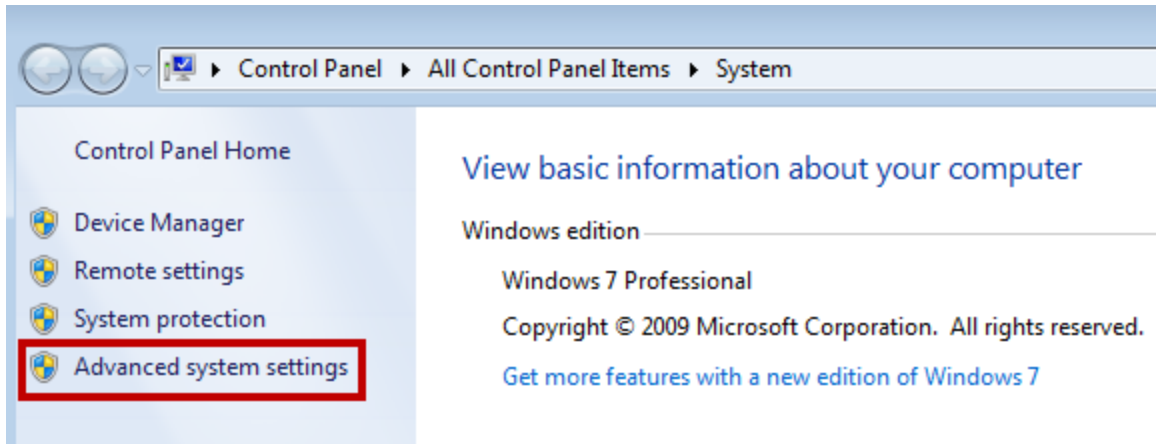


Increase the Size of Windows7 Virtual Memory for Better performance

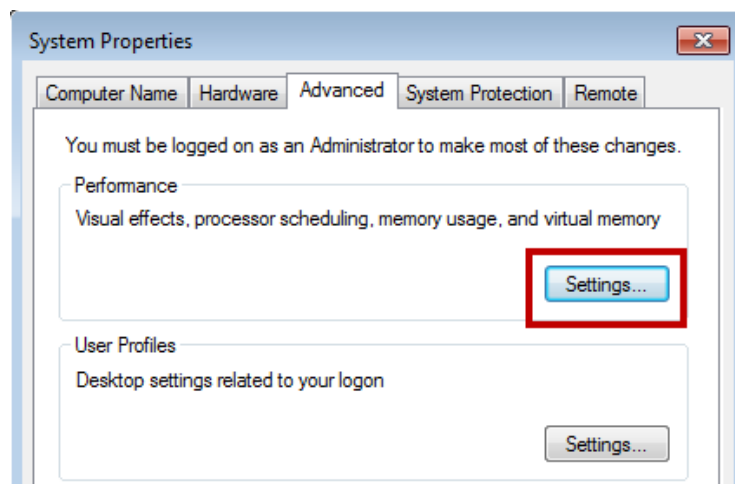
A Virtual memory is nothing but a space on your computers hard drive which is used by the Operating system to store temporary files and other information which is rarely used by the system and other programs. You can increase the size of Windows7 Virtual Memory to make sure the existing programs run faster and get a smooth performance.

To increase the Virtual Memory (Paging File) in Windows 7, follow these steps:

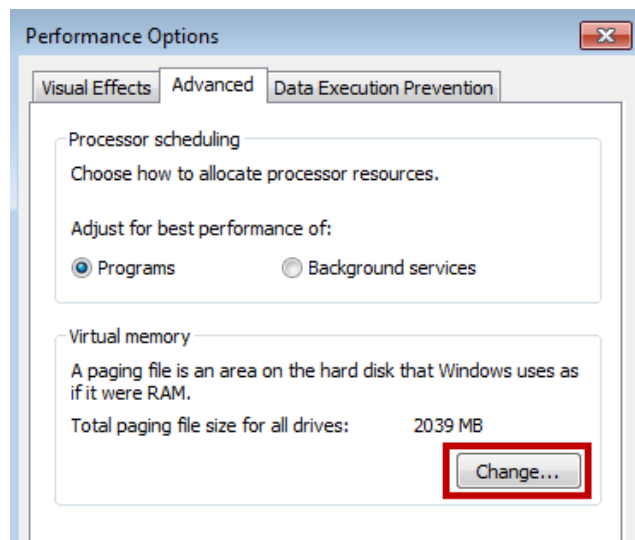
1. From the Start Menu, right click on "My Computer" and select "Properties".
2. In the following window, click "Advanced System Settings"



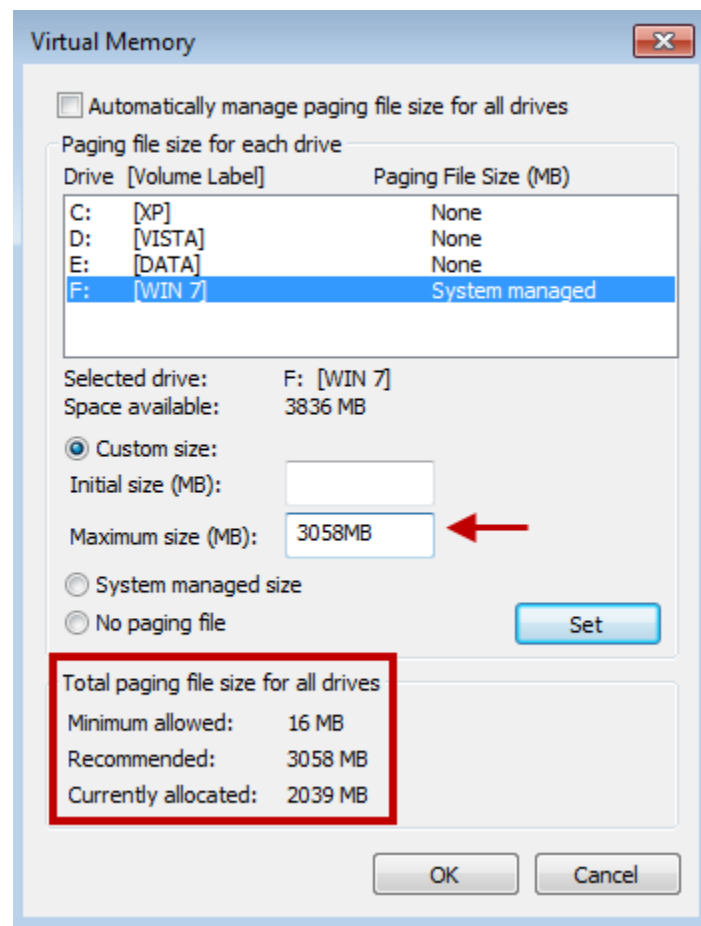
3. In the “Advanced” Tab, click “Settings”



4. In the next window, click the “Advanced” tab again and click “Change” under Virtual memory section



5. Here you will be able to see the current size of Windows 7 virtual memory. This will depend upon the size of your hard disk and RAM, make sure it's not less than system recommended size. Adjust the slider and allocate maximum possible size to the virtual memory



Here you can see the current virtual memory size. Virtual memory called 'paging file' also. In next screen under custom size enter size you want to allocate for virtual memory (paging file). It depends on your hard disk size and physical memory. Make sure it's not less than system recommended size. Normally recommended paging file is 1.5 of physical RAM. In this example recommended size of virtual memory is 4605MB because my windows 7 RAM is 3GB. So, enter 4605MB in Initial size and Maximum Size fields.

Disable the Windows7 Sidebar

The Windows7 sidebar is one of the main reasons of slow performance, if your computer takes a long time to start, you should consider removing the sidebar all together.

Follow these steps:

1. Right click on the Windows 7 sidebar and select " Properties ".
2. On the properties windows uncheck the check box " Start sidebar when Windows Starts "

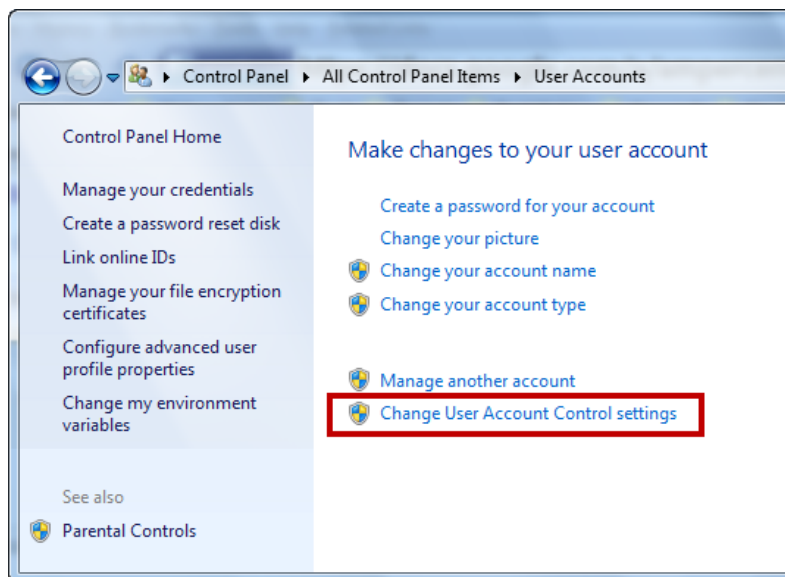
Disable the UAC (User account control) Feature of Windows7

User Account Control (UAC) helps defend your PC against hackers and malicious software. Any time a program wants to make a major change to your computer, UAC lets you know and asks for permission.

If you are the only user of your computer, then UAC control is nothing but a distraction which slows down your computer anyway.

To turn off the UAC feature of Windows7, follow these steps:

1. Open Windows Control Panel and click "User accounts"
2. Click "Change User Account Control Settings"



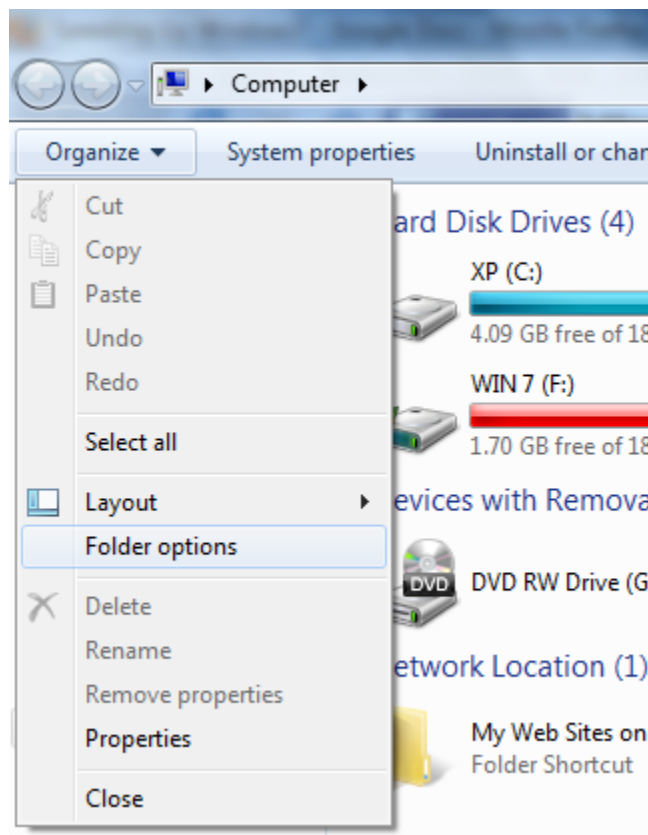
3. Now just drag the Slider towards “Never Notify”.
4. Click “OK” and Reboot your system.

Disable Thumbnail Preview in Windows7

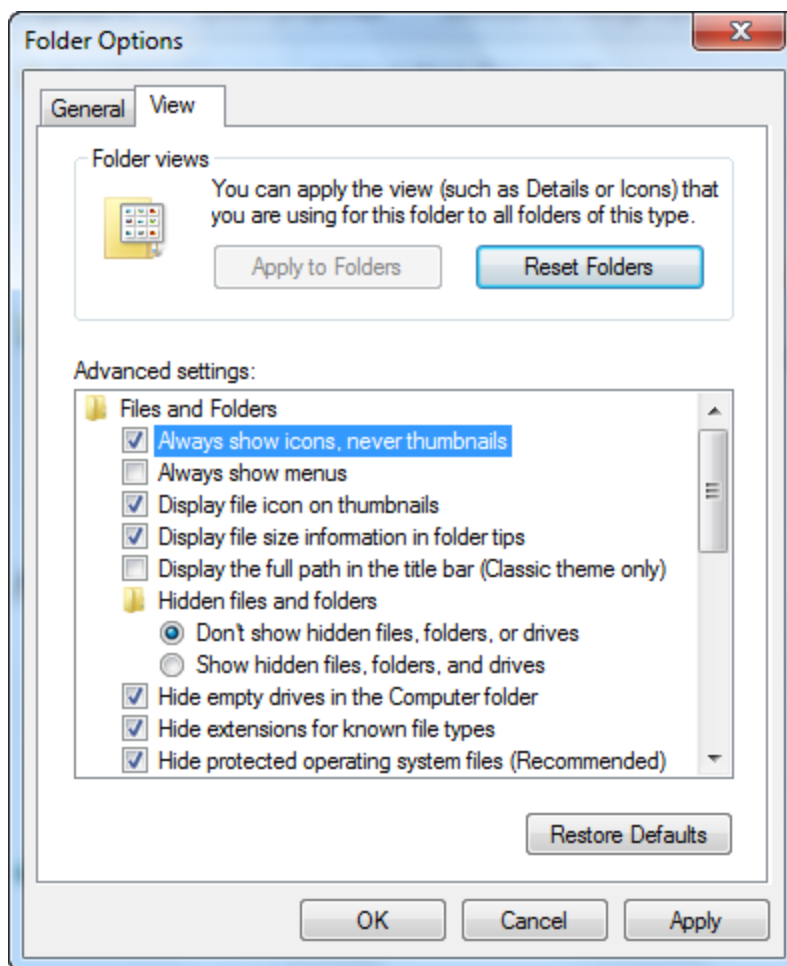
Windows7 shows small thumbnail preview of open windows when you hover over the taskbar window group. By disabling thumbnail previews in Windows7, you will surely speed up file browsing:

To disable thumbnail previews in Windows7, follow these steps:

1. Open “My Computer” and click the “Organize” drop down at the far left of the screen. Select “Folder options”



2. Select the “View” tab and tick the option “ Always show icons, never thumbnails “



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